

RIM PlayBook out at \$499

RIM, the makers of BlackBerry are out with their maiden tablet device PlayBook which is priced similar to the iPad2

HTC Incredible S in India

HTC's Incredible S running FroYo but upgradeable to Gingerbread, is available in India at an MRP of ₹28,900

Agent 001

Sound card dilemma

I am looking forward to purchase a professional budget sound card for my multimedia usage.

I have set aside the following cards please help me decide:

ASUS Xonar D2X

ASUS Xonar DX

ASUS Essence STX

ASUS Essence ST

My budget is around ₹9,000. Kindly suggest me the best card for this budget.



ASUS Xonar DX

I am basically going to use this card for a SOHO studio setup and for gaming. I am presently using a Creative Sound Blaster 24-bit on Windows 7 Ultimate. The present setup is a 5.1 which can be upgraded later. At present, I am working on a project in Haridwar (Uttarakhand) but am originally from Mumbai. Please guide me as I have a pending job at hand which demands quality work. Thanks in advance

Prashant Patel

For your setup, the ASUS Xonar D2X or ASUS Xonar DX makes sense. But you might have to stretch your budget a little to accommodate the D2X. Basically the DX is a stripped down version of the D2X. The D2X has extra SPDIF ports, DTS sound, better DAC. So if you are going to exploit all the functionalities then go for the D2X, else if you want to keep it under your budget then go for the DX which is priced around ₹5,000

Sandy Bridge Rig

I want to upgrade just my processor, RAM, motherboard and graphics card. My requirements include gaming with moderate graphics and basically great performance from almost any latest application that I use. My budget is ₹35,000 and I can stretch it max up to ₹40,000. I'm an Intel and NVIDIA person, am particularly looking at the Core i7-2600K based on Digit's

review. Motherboard should be of high quality and feature rich. I really liked ASUS P8P67 DELUXE. I want 6 - 8GB DDR3 RAM and Video card must be NVIDIA only with at least 1GB GDDR5 memory and 256-bit bus width. I hope it's not too much to ask given my budget! Please give the prices I should expect for each component. Also what rating PSU would I need?

Siddhant P Pardeshi

Considering you are looking at a Sandy Bridge gaming rig, you will have to stretch your budget. Since you are only looking at a processor, RAM, motherboard, graphics card and a PSU, we would suggest the following rig based on your usage :

Processor : Intel Core i7-2600K (around ₹16,000)

Motherboard : ASUS P8P67 Deluxe (around ₹12,000) / MSI P67A-GD65 (₹10,500)

RAM : 2 x 2GB DDR3 Corsair (1333MHz) (around ₹2,200) (₹4,400 for 8 GB)

Video Card : Sapphire HD 5670 (₹5,500) / Zotac GTS 450 (₹9,000)

PSU : Corsair VX550 : ₹4,800

Gaming Rig

I want to build a gaming rig from scratch. I want to play games like Crysis, Assassins Creed, The Witcher, Far Cry 2, Supreme Commander, etc. My budget is ₹20,000 to ₹25,000. Thanks in advance.

Akash Agarwal

You will have to stretch your budget to around 27k if you want a decent graphics card and a UPS in your rig. The rig specifications are as given below.

Processor : AMD Athlon

II X3 440 - ₹3,250

Motherboard : Gigabyte GA-MA785GMT-US2H - ₹3,400

RAM : Corsair 2GB DDR3 1333 MHz - ₹1,125

HDD : 500GB Seagate 7200.12 - ₹1,700

Monitor : Dell 1920IN - ₹5,500

Graphics Card : Sapphire HD 5670 - ₹5,500

Cabinet : CM Elite 310 - ₹1,500

PSU : VIP 350W ₹800

Mouse : Logitech M90 - ₹330

Optical Drive : Sony DVD Writer - ₹1,400
Keyboard : Logitech K100 - ₹265
UPS : APC BR600CI-IN - ₹2,165
Total will come to around ₹27,000

Android Phone under 13k

I am planning to buy Android phone around ₹13,000. I was thinking about Samsung Gio. Do suggest some good models. Brand is not a problem as long as it is LG, Sony Ericsson or Samsung. I am ready to wait for a good phone.

Siddhant P Pardeshi

For the budget you have specified, these are the phones available for you. Samsung Galaxy Fit at ₹10,250 is a recently launched phone. It has a 600MHz processor, 3.31 inch capacitive touchscreen, Android 2.2 version (Froyo), 3G and Wi-Fi and a 5 megapixel camera. LG Optimus One P500 at ₹12,000 is another alternative. The Optimus One P500 has a pretty loaded spec sheet- 600MHz processor, 3.2 inch touchscreen, 3 megapixel camera and Android 2.2 (Froyo) version. The LG App Advisor is pre-loaded, and is quite helpful, considering Android Market doesn't have the best interface around. Samsung Galaxy Ace at ₹14,500 is another new launch. It offers a 800MHz processor, 3.5 inch capacitive touchscreen, 5 megapixel camera and Android 2.2 (Froyo) wrapped with the Touchwiz



LG Optimus One P500

3.0 User Interface. Samsung has loaded this phone with the SWYPE feature, which lets users type out messages without having to lift the finger and touch every individual button. 